

# The Greek Root bio-

The root bio- means life.

Today I am learning to recognise bio-, explain its meaning, build word families and use bio- words in context.

## 1 Discover the Root

The Greek root bio- means life or living things. Use this clue to unlock unfamiliar words.



**biology**

study of life



**biography**

writing about a life



**biodiversity**

variety of living things



**biodegradable**

able to  
break down naturally



**biologist**

a scientist  
who studies life



**biosphere**

places where life exists

## 2 Build the Word

Combine bio- with the word part. Write the complete word.

1. bio- + logy = \_\_\_\_\_
2. bio- + graphy = \_\_\_\_\_
3. bio- + sphere = \_\_\_\_\_
4. bio- + diversity = \_\_\_\_\_
5. bio- + degradable = \_\_\_\_\_
6. bio- + fuel = \_\_\_\_\_

## 3 Root or Not?

Sort the words. Does bio- mean life here?

biology

bicycle

biofuel

biplane

biography

binary

biosphere

rebuild

bio- = life

not bio-

## 4 Read and Notice

Read the passage. Highlight the bio- words.

During a science project, our class explored biodiversity in a wetland. We learned that a biologist studies living things and that the biosphere includes all places on Earth where life exists. We read a short biography of a scientist who studied coral reefs. We also compared plastic with biodegradable packaging and discussed how biofuel can be made from plant material. Each word gave us the same clue: bio- connects the word to life or living things.

Word clue: underline another word part that helps you work out the meaning.

## 5 Word Detective

Choose one bio- word from the passage.

- a Write the word.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- b What other word part can you identify?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- c What does the whole word mean?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- d How does bio- help you understand it?  
\_\_\_\_\_

## 6 Use It in Writing

Use your root knowledge to make the meaning clear.

a A biologist studies \_\_\_\_\_

b Use one bio- word in your own sentence.  
\_\_\_\_\_

### Parent check

☐ recognises bio- as meaning life

☐ uses other word parts to infer meaning

☐ distinguishes bio- from bi- meaning two

☐ uses a bio- word accurately in context